THE BURGESS PERSIAN LETTERS

Edited by BENJAMIN SCHWARTZ

PART V

[EDWARD BURGESS TO MRS. HENRY BURGESS] *Tabreez, June 30, 1844*

I am perhaps, and I thank God for it, the most contented European in this country; whenever I get discontented with my lot, I think how much better off I am than a clerk in Manchester, worked eight, nine, or ten hours a day in that filthy climate, and when he has done his work at night having no resource or amusement but to go to a tavern and drink brandy and water. Mr Zohrab who has just left this for England, to join his brother, who has a small commission business in Liverpool, thinks that in going to England in this way he will get into "such good society." Why the best society he can hope to get into will be something like that of Mr Perker's clerk (Pickwick) at the Magpie and Stump. I advised him, by no means to leave these countries if he could get any good place but so mad was he about England where he has never been, that he said if he was offered a place for a thousand a year under the British Govt to remain in Turkey or Persia he would not take it. And all because he thinks he is going to get into "good society." I did not like to vex him by undeceiving him, which would perhaps have been impossible, so I let him start expecting to find the streets of Liverpool paved with gold and silver.

It is about three p. m. Sunday the heat of the day is beginning to abate and I shall as soon as I have finished these few sentences, take a walk to a summer palace and pleasure grounds belonging to the Prince, which is about fifteen minutes walk from where I live; this is a very favorite resort of mine; the grounds are about three quarters of a mile long by nearly half a mile broad, and contain almost every sort of tree and shrub which will thrive in this climate. Some parts are laid out as vineyards others as almond and apple orchards and other fruit trees, and there are avenues of poplars and some forest trees which are not common here amongst which I may remark oaks, as they are rare. Here and there, where the paths cross, black bushy elm trees are planted (the witch elm I believe) which have a shade so thick that they form in this climate a more agreeable abode than any room. Lady McNeill once passed three months of the summer under the shade of trees like these near Tehran. The roses are now out and I often come back with large bouquets of them. Now could I enjoy this at Manchester?

1st July 7 a. m. I took my walk yesterday evening as I intended and took my dogs with me. Amongst them is a young pointer which one of my Greek friends

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